

Heat Press (5-in-1)

WHAT'S IN THE KIT

- 5-in-1 heat press machine
- Hat press attachment
- Mug press attachment
- Plate press attachment



QUICK-START GUIDE

1. Design artwork (mirror it for transfers!) and print on transfer paper, or cut heat-transfer vinyl with the Cricut.
2. Set temperature and time for your material (guides included).
3. Adult operates the press — it gets seriously hot.
4. Position, press, peel. Instant product.

FULL LESSONS IN THIS GUIDE

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PRO TIP: Pairs with the Cricut for vinyl designs — check both out for the full production line.

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LESSON · GRADES 6-8

Product Launch Lab

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will design a cohesive product line
- Students will calculate material costs and set prices
- Students will pitch a brand with a physical product

MATERIALS

- Heat press + attachments (adult-operated)
- Transfer paper or heat-transfer vinyl (via Cricut)
- Blank shirts/mugs (small batch)
- Cost worksheet and pitch rubric

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Teams develop a brand: name, logo, one shirt design, one mug design.
2. Design rule: mirror text for transfers — demonstrate the backwards-shirt cautionary tale.
3. Cost the line: blanks + transfer materials + 'labor' = unit cost; set retail price.
4. Production day: teams prep and align; adult runs the press.
5. Pitch day: brand story, product demo, and pricing logic in 3 minutes.
6. Class 'investors' allocate imaginary funding to the strongest pitches.

ACTIVITY

Product Launch Lab — brands with real pressed products and defensible pricing. The mirrored-text mistake will happen to someone, and that shirt becomes a legendary teaching artifact.

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LESSON · GRADES 9-12

Merch Business Simulation

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will operate a small production business end to end
- Students will track actual costs, revenue, and margin
- Students will fulfill orders to deadline and quality standards

MATERIALS

- Heat press + all attachments
- Inventory: blanks, transfer vinyl, mugs (tracked)
- Real sales context: school event, club fundraiser, spirit store
- Ledger template: costs, orders, revenue, margin

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Secure the real context: an event or fundraiser that wants actual merch.
2. Product planning from real demand: survey what people would buy at what price.
3. Pre-orders with a deadline — production planning now has stakes.
4. Production runs with QC standards; seconds get logged, not sold.
5. Fulfillment and money handling per school rules.
6. Close the books: actual margin vs. projection, and a one-page 'lessons for next season.'

ACTIVITY

Merch Business Simulation — real pre-orders, real production deadlines, real margins for a school cause. Closing the books against projections is applied business education, with profit.